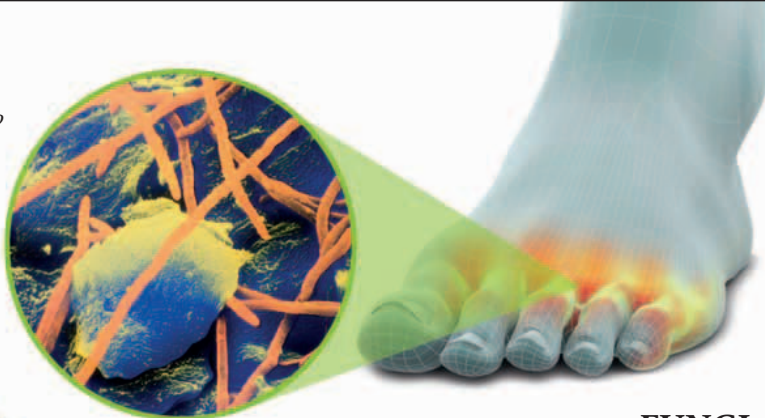


► **ATHLETE'S FOOT** *This close-up view shows filaments (orange) of the athlete's foot fungus growing between flakes of skin. Athlete's foot causes soreness, itching, and cracked skin.*



WOW!

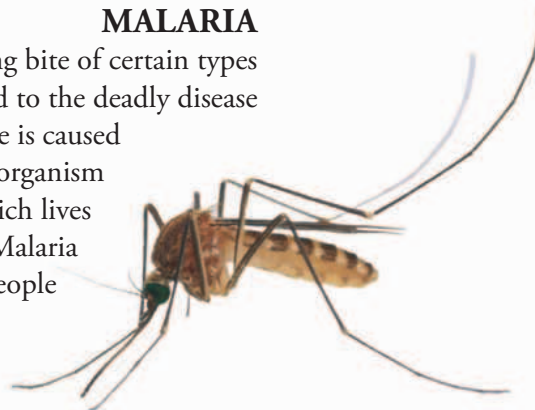
The smallest viruses are so tiny that 400 million of them would fit inside a period.

FUNGI

Mushrooms and molds belong to a category of organisms called fungi. Most fungi grow in soil or on rotting matter, but a few types can grow on or inside the human body. Athlete's foot is a disease caused by fungi that grow as a network of tiny threads through damp skin.

MALARIA

The bloodsucking bite of certain types of mosquitoes can lead to the deadly disease malaria. This disease is caused by a single-celled organism called *Plasmodium*, which lives inside mosquitoes. Malaria kills up to a million people a year worldwide.

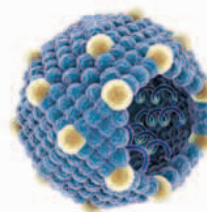


VIRUS SHAPES

There are millions of different viruses. Scientists classify them according to their size and their shape, both of which are amazingly varied. Some look like tubes, boxes, or golf balls. Others are more complex and look like tiny, man-made machines. Three important types of virus are shown below.



▲ **SPIRAL** *This virus has a corkscrew shape, with the virus's DNA coiled up inside. Measles is caused by a spiral virus.*



▲ **ICOSAHEDRAL** *Responsible for causing colds and polio, these viruses have a coat made of twenty triangular faces.*



▲ **COMPLEX** *Resembling tiny spacecraft, complete with landing gear to settle on cells, these viruses attack bacteria.*